

Cole Preston

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

East Asian Political Economy, International Trade, Industrial Policy, Geoeconomics

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz

Santa Cruz, CA

Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics and Economics, Minor in East Asian Studies

Sept. 2024 – Expected Fall 2027

Keio University

Tokyo, Japan

UCEAP Keio International Program

Sept. 2026 – Aug. 2027

- Focus: Japanese foreign policy, competition policy, public policy, China–Japan relations, money and banking, and Japanese language
- Honors: UCEAP Duttonhaver Scholarship; UCEAP Global Scholarship

De Anza College

Cupertino, CA

A.A.-T Economics for Transfer | Magna Cum Laude

Sept. 2022 – June 2024

LEADERSHIP & EXPERIENCE

UCSC Investment Banking Academy

Santa Cruz, CA

Advisor; formerly Co-President and Head of Equity Research

Mar. 2025 – Present

- As Co-President (Nov. 2025 – Jun. 2026), led club operations, setting weekly agendas and programming on finance, valuation, and markets; advising the executive team remotely while abroad since Jun. 2026
- As Head of Equity Research (Mar. 2025 – Nov. 2025), organized workshops on financial statement analysis, valuation modeling, and investment thesis development

UCSC Investment Fund

Santa Cruz, CA

TMT Sector Head

Oct. 2025 – Jun. 2026

- Led the TMT sector group, delivering a 112% gain across covered positions, the fund's top-performing sector
- Directed weekly research on valuation drivers, competitive positioning, and the macroeconomic, regulatory, and geopolitical risks behind sector recommendations

The Riekes Center for Human Enhancement

Menlo Park, CA

Coach and Instructor

Aug. 2018 – Aug. 2026

- Coached students through individualized strength, conditioning, and mobility programs, and led group classes and daily facility operations

SKILLS

Technical: Python, R, Econometrics, Regression Analysis, Data Analysis

Languages: English (native); Japanese (beginner)

Finance: Financial Statement Analysis, DCF and Comparables Valuation, Equity Research